

85-percent boost

That is the percent by which smartphone sales have improved this year as compared to last year, with Nokia topping with 30 percent share

Social Search on Google

Google has announced plans to roll out social search features, which involve mixing regular search with publicly available data on your friend's social streams

Audio-Technica M50

One of our favourites so far

The Audio-Technica M50 was launched ages ago but is still one of the most talked about headphones in the world. So naturally we were eager to put it through an aural examination of our own.

Right from the outset they remind you of the Sennheiser HD 280 Pros; whether it's the foldable design or the coiled cable. Where they differ is the build, look and feel and sound quality, with the M50s raging past the 280 Pros.

The headphones seems to be well built and very neutral indeed, in terms of audio quality. By and large, headphones cannot come close to the experience offered by good quality reference speakers, but the Audio-

Technica M50s came comfortably in the vicinity of the sound signature of the Genelecs we had with us sometime back.



All frequencies were rendered true to recording, we would place it more towards the brighter side of sound colouration. On a few tracks we could even make out clipping at low volumes. To maintain a high quality source we tested these cans on the Asus Xonar Essence STX sound card. They are very unforgiving on low quality

audio. Lower bit rates will be as apparent as Justin Bieber at a death metal concert. A funny inconsistency is that while the seal offered by the pads was quite tight, we noticed a disturbance if you happened to sit right in front of an airconditioner's draft. At a suggested price of ₹7,700 they come recommended to anyone who wants to listen to true-to-source audio.

Siddharth Parvathy

Specifications

Type: Closed-back dynamic earpads; Driver: 45 mm Neodymium; Frequency Response: 15-28,000 Hz; Sensitivity: 99 dB; Impedance: 38 ohms; Weight: 284 g

Contact

Pristine Note

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Web site: www.pristinote.com

Price: ₹7,700

7.5
10

Features 7.0
Performance 7.5
Build Quality 7.5
Value for money 7.0

Samsung Nexus S

The tie that didn't quite bind

Specifications

Display: 4-inch, 480 x 800 pixels, S-LCD; OS: Android 2.3; camera: 5 MP; Storage: 16 GB; battery: 1,500 mAh; Weight: 129 grams

Contact

Samsung India

Phone: 1800 3000 8282

Web site: www.in.samsung.com

Price: ₹29,590

6.5
10

Features 7.0
Performance 6.5
Build Quality 6.5
Value for money 6.0

The Nexus S requires no introduction, and is quite a revered device and now that we've tested it, we're still scratching our heads over what the fuss was about. The Nexus S is typical Samsung – piano black, with a flat front and a contoured battery cover. Although lighter than the Incredible S, it feels heavier and is thicker and longer.

Right away, the S-LCD is inferior to the display on the Incredible S – it's not as bright, and neither does it have as good colours. Incidentally, the FB app is quirky – we noticed comments posted weren't available even on refreshing. We had issues with

calls on two occasions, despite at least eight attempts, the capacitive display wouldn't register a swipe to accept an incoming call. The on-screen keypad is decent – certainly at par with the Sony Ericsson Xperia Arc, although we made more mistakes than on the Incredible S.

Performance in-call was good, although the weak ringer and weaker vibration leaves a lot to be desired and resulted in 11 missed calls in three



days. Music quality on the Nexus S is pretty good with good bass and a pleasing mid-range.

At a price of ₹29,590, the Nexus S is a little too expensive. We're sorry to break it to you, but while patches might be very frequent, this will only satisfy geeks wanting a device to tinker with, and not people wanting a good "phone". It's not a bad handset, but there are better ones around for less.

Michael Browne